

RUINSTARS

Squad Operations In A Dying Galaxy

MISSIONS

Version 20251228



MISSIONS

TACTICAL ENGAGEMENTS ACROSS A GALAXY IN RUINS

"We once believed war would end when the stars themselves dimmed. We were wrong. The stars are gone, and still we fight over scraps of metal, over relics of dead gods, over the idea that any of this still matters."

Every mission you read in this record was real once. Squads bled for these orders. Some triumphed and carved their marks into the ruins; others vanished beneath the dust of worlds that no longer have names.

If you are holding this field manual, you are part of what remains. Learn these operations well. Out there, knowing which ruin to hold (or which to burn) means the difference between survival and extinction."

Excerpt from the Warfront Archives, Cycle 2279.6

Across the shattered frontier of the galaxy, war is constant. Squads of elite operatives clash in the ruins of cities, alien jungles, desecrated temples, and endless wastelands, each battle a fleeting spark in the dark expanse of the Ruinstars. These are not grand crusades of empire, but desperate struggles fought by the few who dare to step onto the battlefield when hope has long since burned away.

This section collects the missions, battlefields, and scripted operations that define warfare in the Ruinstars setting. Within these pages, commanders will find everything they need to wage battle, from quick-play engagements and solo challenges to full three-part operations and sprawling, multi-stage campaigns. Every victory and defeat shapes the next confrontation; every decision carries the weight of survival.

Each mission offers unique tactical puzzles and narrative flavor, challenging you to adapt your strategy to shifting objectives and hostile environments. Scripted Operations weave these battles into connected arcs: mini-campaigns that tell stories of ambition, corruption, and sacrifice. Whether you fight for the glory of the Human Hegemony, the zeal of the Sanctified Legion, the hunger of the Swarm, or the whispers of the Silent Choir, every operation offers a chance to carve your name into the scars of the galaxy.

PLAYING A MISSION

Your Squad is deployed for desperate struggles fought by the few who dare to step onto the battlefield when hope has long since burned away. These missions are designed to be played as quick, one-off skirmishes perfect for pick-up or competitive play.

Each Mission is a single battle pitting your Squad against its enemies, generally lasting 4 Turns. Victory in these engagements is typically decided by calculating the total Mission Points (MP) scored by each Squad at the end of Turn 4.

Alternatively, you can use these missions to build your own Campaign. A full Campaign is structured into three distinct Operations, and each Operation is composed of three Missions, totaling nine confrontations. In Campaign play, the winning Squad selects one of the Mission rewards to apply to their Squad, while the losing Squad gains the remaining reward. These missions offer unique tactical puzzles and narrative flavor, challenging you to adapt your strategy to shifting objectives and hostile environments.

Whether you are playing a quick one-off mission or a long, epic campaign, the rules for playing each Mission are the same:

1. Select a Mission
2. Select a Battlefield
3. Set up your Squads
4. Play!

MISSION LIST

1 - SECURE THE ZONE

"Claim ground, hold fast."

Throughout the battle, both sides contest key areas of the warzone. Whoever can consistently secure ground will dictate the flow of the fight.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- DA Deployment Zone A
- DB Deployment Zone B
- O1 Objective 1
- O2 Objective 2
- O3 Objective 3

SETUP

Place 3 Objective markers in the center of the West, Central, and East tiles.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

If a Squad controls all 3 Objectives at the end of any Turn, they gain +1 MP immediately (once per game).

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, Squads score 1 MP per Objective they control.

CAMPAIGN REWARDS

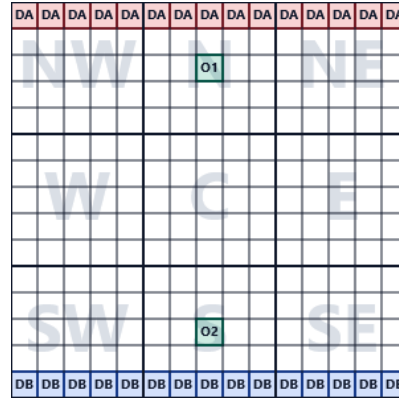
- **Field Stabilizers:** One Unit gains +1 ARM during Turn 1 of its next mission.
- **Forward Command:** +1 TO during any Turn in the next mission.

2 - HOLD THE LINE

"The enemy breaks upon our wall."

Victory favors the steadfast. The longer you hold, the stronger your claim.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- DA Deployment Zone A
- DB Deployment Zone B
- O1 Objective 1
- O2 Objective 2

SETUP

Place two Objective markers in the center of the North and South tiles.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Units in cover Adjacent to an Objective gain +1 ARM against ranged attacks.

VICTORY

At the end of each turn after the first, Squads score 2 MP per Objective they control.

CAMPAIGN REWARDS

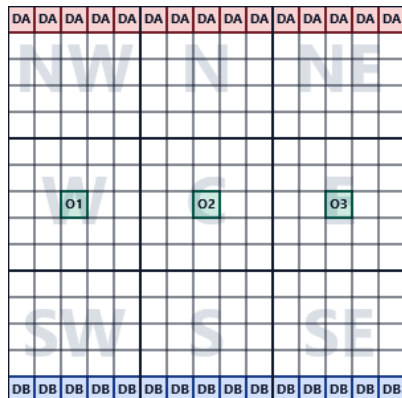
- **Tactical Resupply:** Select one Unit to be always treated as in Cover for the next mission.
- **Healed Injury:** One Unit may immediately remove one Injury (excluding Deceased).

3 - POWER CYCLE

"Reactivate the grid before the enemy shuts it down."

A dormant facility flickers to life. Reactors surge, systems fail, and both sides fight to keep control of unstable nodes.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Power Node 1
- ☐ O2 Power Node 2
- ☐ O3 Power Node 3

SETUP

Place 3 Power Node markers in the center of the West, Central, and East tiles. All Power Nodes start the mission as "Inactive".

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

At the start of each Turn, all Power Nodes are reset to "Inactive" state.

Mission Action: Toggle Node (1 ACT): The Unit toggles the Active state of a Node they control. Active Nodes emit dangerous radiation: At the end of each Turn, all Units Adjacent to an Active node take 1 Damage.

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, Squads score 1 MP per Active Node they control.

CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Voltage Spikes:** Select one Unit's weapon to gain RLT (Relentless) or RND1 (Rending 1) in the next mission.
- **Technician Assist:** Select one Unit to gain Technician 1 (perform one Mission action for 1 less ACT) for the next mission.

4 - SABOTAGE

"They built it. You break it."

A vital structure powers the enemy advance. One force must destroy it; the other, defend it at all costs.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Attacker Deployment Zone
- ☐ DD Defender Deployment Zone
- ☐ S1 Sabotage Target 1
- ☐ S2 Sabotage Target 2

SETUP

Select one Squad to be the Defender, the other the Attacker.

Place two larger structures in the West and East tiles and one Sabotage marker on the corner of each structure.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Mission Action: Sabotage (1 ACT): An Attacker Unit that controls a Sabotage marker may perform this Action. Remove the sabotaged structure from the battlefield. All Units within or Adjacent to that structure take 2 Damage.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, the Attacker scores 3 MP for each destroyed structure. Defender scores 3 MP for each remaining intact.

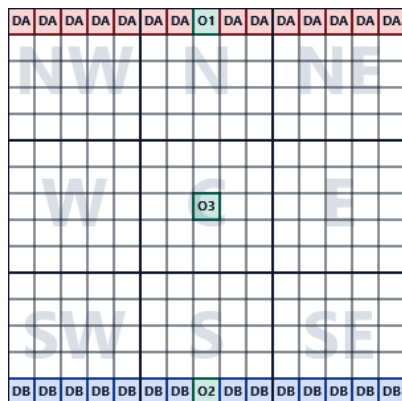
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Demo Expert:** One Unit gains "Demo charge" (a free Grenade action) to use once in the next mission.
- **Quick Prep:** One Unit gains +1 ACT in Turn 1 of the next mission.

5 - PUSH THE LINE

"Drive them back step by step."
Advance across the battlefield and seize ground from the enemy.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Objective 1
- ☐ O2 Objective 2
- ☐ O3 Objective 3

SETUP

Place 3 Objectives: one centered on each Squad's Deployment edge and one at the exact center.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

If you control the enemy Objective at the end of Turn 3 or earlier, gain an additional +1 MP bonus (once per game).

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, score 1 MP if you control your own Objective, 2 MP if you control the center, and 3 MP if you control the enemy's.

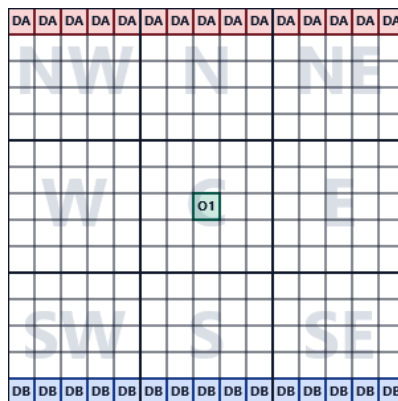
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Aggressive Push:** One Unit gains +1 ACT in Turn 1 of the next mission.
- **Rapid Deployment:** One Unit may perform a free move after its deployment. If the next mission deploys Units before Turn 1, perform this move after all Units have been deployed, before Turn 1.

6 - CENTERPOINT

"All roads lead to ruin."
The battle converges on a single decisive location.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Objective

SETUP

Place 1 Objective at the exact center of the Battlefield.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, the Squad controlling the central Objective scores 6 MP.

CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Decisive Strike:** One Unit gets one Spoil of War for the next mission.
- **Weapon Calibration:** Select one Unit's weapon to gain RLT (Relentless) or RND1 (Rending 1) in the next mission.

7 - RECOVER INTEL

"Retrieve the data before the uplink burns."
Valuable intel lies scattered among the ruins.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Intel 1
- ☐ O2 Intel 2
- ☐ O3 Intel 3

SETUP

Place 3 Data Core markers in the center of the West, Central, and East tiles.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Mission Action: Collect Intel (1 ACT): A Unit that controls a Data Core may perform this action. That Unit now carries the Data Core. Units may only carry one Data Core each. If a carrier is Taken Out, the Data Core drops on that Units position.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, score 2 MP per Data Core carried by your Units.

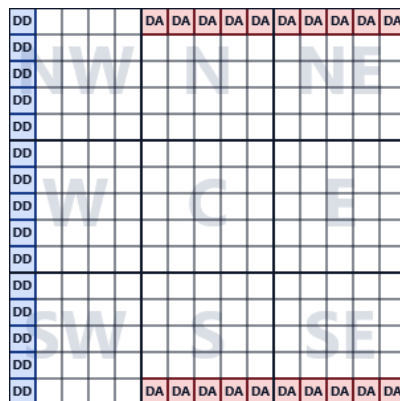
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Intelligence Priority:** Start the next mission with +1 TO. Once during the next mission, you may re-roll any number of your TO dice.
- **Treasure Trove:** The Squad may spend an additional 5GP on Weapons and Skills for the next mission. At the end of that mission, remove the added Gear.

8 - AMBUSH

"Intercept the courier before they vanish into the wasteland."
One side must extract a critical asset; the other must stop them.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Attacker Deployment Zone
- ☐ DD Defender Deployment Zone

SETUP

Select one Squad to be the Defender, the other the Attacker.

Defender secretly selects one Unit (excluding the Leader) to be the carrier of the Intel.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy before Turn 1. Defender deploys all their Units on the Western battlefield edge first. Then Attacker Squad deploys all their Units on the Northern edge of the North and Northeast tiles, or the Southern edge of the South and Southeast tiles.

SPECIAL

When a Unit carrying the Intel is Taken Out, place the Core on its position. It can be recovered and carried off by any Unit.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, if the Defender Squad is carrying the Intel and the carrier is on the Eastern edge of the East tile, Defender wins the mission. Attacker wins in all other cases.

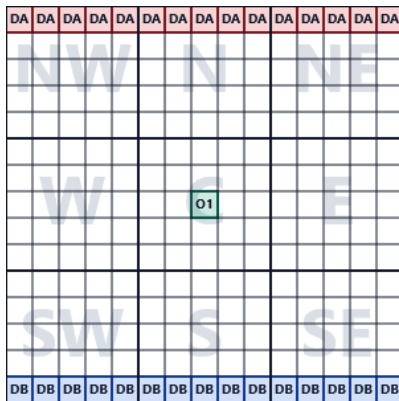
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Disruption Scan:** One Unit gains +1 MSK (Melee Skill) or +1 RSK (Ranged Skill) for the next mission.
- **Targeted Strike:** The enemy Leader gains -1 ARM (minimum 1) for the next mission.

9 - RELAY RUN

"Grab the beacon and get it home."
A beacon must be secured and relayed back to command.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Beacon

SETUP

Place one Beacon Objective at the Battlefield center.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

The Beacon is a marker that can be Picked Up. While carrying the Beacon, Units have -1 ACT (minimum 1).

VICTORY

A Squad scores 6 MP if any Unit exits their own Battlefield edge carrying the Beacon.

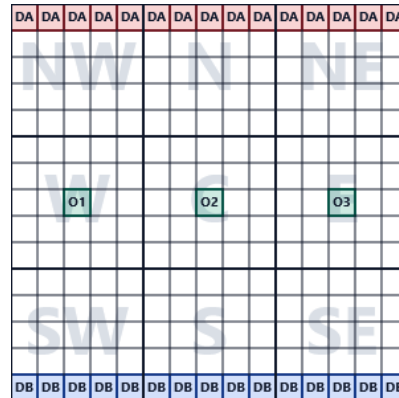
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **TO Optimization:** During the next mission, the Squad may re-roll TOs once.
- **Swift Runner:** One Unit gains Swift (first Dash action costs 0 ACT) in the next mission.

10 - SEARCH AND RECOVER

"A powerful artifact is buried here. Find it before the enemy does."
You don't know where it is, but the longer you search, the better your odds.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A ☐ DB Deployment Zone B
- ☐ O1 Search 1 ☐ O2 Search 2
- ☐ O3 Search 3

SETUP

Place 3 Search markers in the center of the West, Center, and East tiles.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Mission Action: Search (2ACT)

A Unit that Controls a Search Marker may spend 2ACT to search it. Roll 1D6. This roll cannot be modified or re-rolled by using TOs.

- On the first searched marker, the Artifact is found on a roll of 1
- On the second searched marker, the Artifact is found on a roll of 1 or 2
- On the third searched marker, the Artifact is found automatically

After searching a marker, remove it from the Battlefield. Once found, the Artifact is carried by the Unit that found it.

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, the Squad carrying the artifact scores 2 MP.

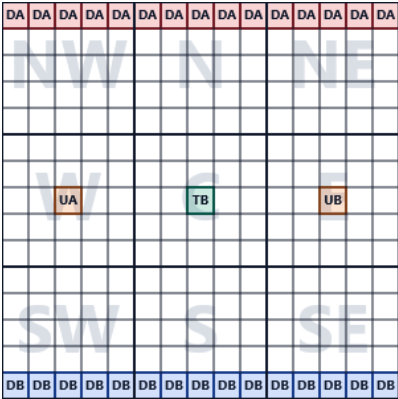
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Ancient Artifact:** The carrier gains one Spoil of War. If it is not Taken Out by the end of the mission, it may keep that Spoil of War. If the Unit is Taken Out by the end of the mission, remove that Spoil of War.
- **Preemptive Strike:** Select one enemy Unit to start the mission with -1 HIT.

11 - COMMITMENT PROTOCOL

"Power must build before the final strike."
Energy charges build throughout the fight until a decisive moment of release.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- DA Deployment Zone A
- DB Deployment Zone B
- TB Transmit Beacon
- UA Uplink Node Alpha
- UB Uplink Node Beta

SETUP

Place 2 Uplink Node markers in the center of the West and East tiles. Place one Transmit Beacon in the center of the Central tile. Set up a tracker for each Squad's Data Packets, starting at zero.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Mission Action: Uplink (1ACT): A Unit that Controls an Uplink Node increases its Squad's Data Packets by 1.

Mission Action: Transmit (1 ACT): A Unit that Controls the Transmit Beacon reduces its Squad's Data Packets by 1 and scores 1 MP. This can only be done in Turns 3 and 4.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, the Squad with the most MP wins the Mission. In case of a tie, the Squad with the highest remaining Data Packets wins the mission.

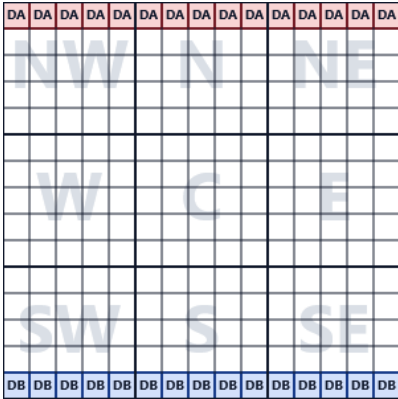
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- Energy Overflow:** One Unit gains +1 ACT in any one Turn in the next Mission (announce when activating).
- Tactical Reversal:** Once in the next mission, any Unit may spend 1 ACT to add 2 TOs to its Squad.

12 - ATTRITION

"No prisoners."
Your orders are simple: outkill the enemy.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- DA Deployment Zone A
- DB Deployment Zone B

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

VICTORY

Each time a Unit is Taken Out, the enemy Squad scores MPs equal to that Unit's Force Value (FV).

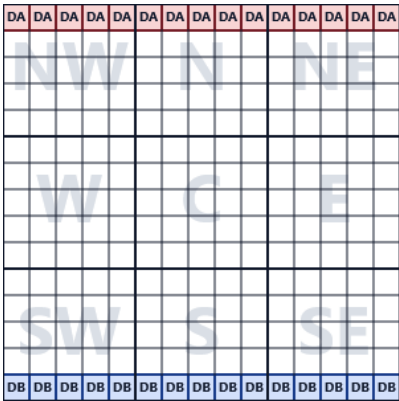
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- Aggressive Momentum:** One Unit gains +1 MSK or +1 RSK the first time it performs a Ranged or Melee combat Action in the next mission.
- Reinforced Armor:** One Unit gains +1 ARM (Armor) during Turn 1 of the next mission.

13 - LAST STAND

"Stand your ground until nothing moves."
The battle grinds to dust. Only the unbroken remain.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, the squad with the highest total FV of Standing Units scores 2 MP.

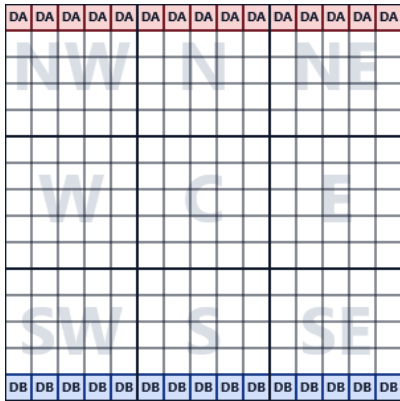
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- Veteran Status:** One Unit permanently gains +1 SKL on its Melee weapons.
- Urgent Treatment:** One Unit may immediately heal one of its Injuries.

14 - ASSASSINATE

"Cut off the head, the body dies."
Hunt down the enemy commander.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Leaders gain +1 ACT for this mission.

VICTORY

If the enemy Leader is Taken Out, your Squad immediately scores 6 MP.

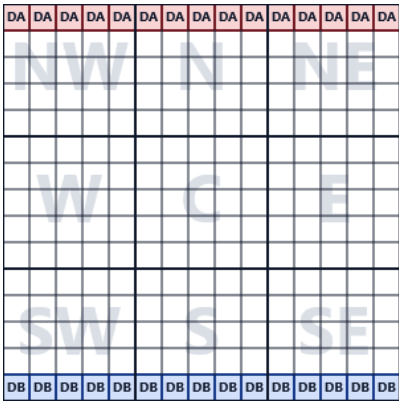
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- Intel Leak:** In the next mission, enemy Leader gains -1 ARM (minimum 1).
- Strategize Bonus:** Once during the next mission, a Unit may spend 1 ACT to gain 2 TOs.

15 - RIVALS

"Settle the score."
Two Units meet on the battlefield, bound by vengeance or destiny.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B

SETUP

Each Squad secretly selects one Rival Unit (not the Leader). Reveal simultaneously after deployment.

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

SPECIAL

Rivals' weapons gain +1 ATT and +1 SKL against each other. In addition, Rivals may only be targeted in combat by the enemy Rival.

VICTORY

If your Rival Takes Out the enemy Rival, score 6 MP. If both Rivals are still Standing at the end of the mission, the mission is a draw (randomly select rewards).

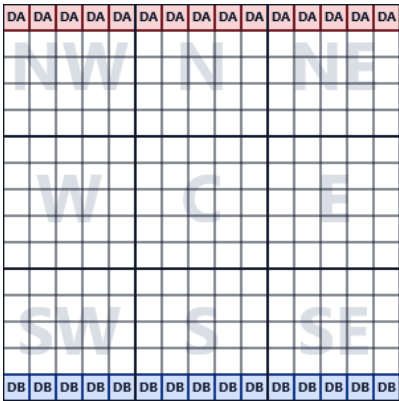
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Personal Vendetta:** In the next mission, select one enemy Unit (excluding the Leader). Your Units gain +1 SKL (Ranged or Melee Skill) each time that enemy is targeted in combat.
- **Defensive Stance:** One Unit gains Tough 1 (re-roll 1 Melee Save die) in the next mission.

16 - ENCROACH

"Push deep and hold the line."
Dominate enemy territory with strength of arms.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



- ☐ DA Deployment Zone A
- ☐ DB Deployment Zone B

DEPLOYMENT

Both Squads deploy on their battlefield edge (North or South) before Turn 1.

VICTORY

At the end of each Turn, the Squad with the highest total FV of Standing Units that are not Adjacent to any enemies and that are closer to the enemy deployment edge than their own deployment edge scores 2 MP.

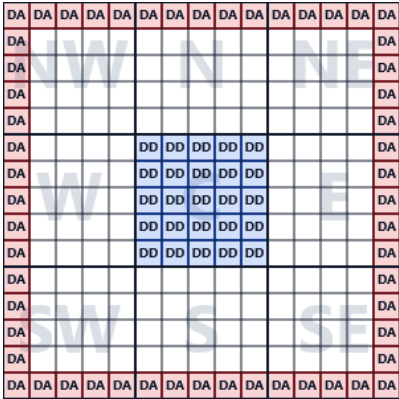
CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Overwhelming Presence:** Once in the next mission, instead of rolling for TOs, get 4 TOs.
- **Deep Strike:** One Unit may perform a free move after its deployment. If the next mission deploys Units before Turn 1, perform this move after all Units have been deployed.

17 - EVAC POINT

"Rendezvous or die trying."
The dropship waits only moments—reach it before the storm consumes the battlefield.

BATTLEFIELD DIAGRAM



☐ DA Attacker Deployment Zone ☐ DD Defender Deployment Zone

SETUP

The Central Tile of the battlefield is the Evac Zone.
Select one Squad to be the Attacker, the other is the Defender.

DEPLOYMENT

Squads deploy before Turn 1. First, Defender Squad deploys anywhere in the central Tile.
Then Attacker Squad deploys before on any battlefield edge.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 4, if the total FV of Standing Defender Units that are on the central tile is equal to or higher than the total FV of Standing Attacker Units on the central tile, Defender Squad wins the mission. Attacker Squad wins in all other cases.

CAMPAIGN REWARDS

- **Extraction Gear:** One Unit gains Grappling Hook (ignore vertical distance when climbing up or down) in the next mission.
- **Resourceful Salvage:** One Unit gains a MedPack (spend 1 ACT to recover 1D3 lost HIT) to use once in the next mission.

BATTLEFIELDS

After selecting a Mission, pick or randomly select one of the following battlefields. The Mission will be played on that Battlefield.

The Galaxy is a dangerous and deadly place; each Battlefield has **Effects** that affect your Units or transform the Battlefield itself.

Use your own battlemats, or use our print-at-home Battlefields with the tiles and Paces pre-marked in a grid.

THE RUINED CITY

SETUP

Dense terrain, ruined buildings and corners

EFFECTS

Collapse: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random tile that has not collapsed. For each terrain element on that tile and for each Pace of height of that terrain element, deal 1 Damage to each Unit within that terrain element's footprint or Adjacent to that terrain element, then remove it from the battlefield.

PRINT-AT-HOME

- [The Ruined City - A4](#)
- [The Ruined City - US Letter](#)

Once a bustling metropolis, the city now lies in ruins, its skyline broken by jagged silhouettes of collapsed towers and scorched facades. Streets that once thrived with life are choked with debris, the remnants of homes, businesses, and dreams reduced to ash and rubble. Shadows of destruction linger in the form of burnt-out vehicles and craters that scar the land, while the acrid smell of smoke and decay hangs in the air.

THE FACILITY

SETUP

Corridors, tight quarters, small chambers.

EFFECTS

Darkness: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random Tile. Until the end of the Turn, Units on that Tile cannot be targeted in Ranged Combat.

PRINT-AT-HOME

- [The Facility - A4](#)
- [The Facility - US Letter](#)

The industrial facility stands as a monument to neglect, its once-thrumming machinery now silent and encased in layers of rust. Massive gears and conveyor belts hang motionless, their surfaces corroded and flecked with peeling paint, hinting at decades of disuse. Cracked windows let in shafts of pale light that illuminate the grime-covered floors littered with broken tools and tangled wires.

THE JUNGLE

SETUP

Dense foliage, little to no elevated terrain.

EFFECTS

Stinging Cloud: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random Standing Unit from each Squad. That Unit moves 1 Pace three times in random directions (roll three times). If that Unit cannot make a valid move because of wall or other obstacle, it takes 1 Melee Damage.

The alien jungle pulses with a life both mesmerizing and menacing, its dense canopy blotting out the sky and casting the undergrowth in an eternal twilight. Massive, twisted trees with glowing veins of bioluminescent sap tower above, their roots forming treacherous mazes through the thick, spongy ground. Vines slither like serpents, some twitching with sentience, while predatory plants snap at anything that brushes their razor-edged leaves.

THE ALIEN HIVE

SETUP

Caverns, tight quarters, no elevated terrain

EFFECTS

Noxious Gas: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random Tile. All Units on that Tile take 1 Damage.

The alien hive looms like a grotesque monolith, its surface an undulating mass of organic textures that pulse faintly with a sickly bioluminescent glow. Towering spires of chitin and resin twist skyward, connected by sinewy bridges that shimmer with an oily sheen. The air is thick and humid, carrying a metallic tang that clings to the throat with every breath. Inside, winding tunnels spiral downward into a labyrinth of chambers, their walls coated in sticky, fibrous webs that pulse rhythmically, as if alive.

THE CURSED TEMPLE

SETUP

Dense terrain, ruined buildings and corners.

EFFECTS

Cursed Spirits: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random Unit from each Squad. That Unit is overtaken by the temple's restless spirits and immediately attacks the closest Unit in Combat, SquadMate or enemy.

The cursed temple rises from the earth like a jagged scar, its crumbling stone walls etched with the maddening sigils of ancient, terrible gods. A perpetual gloom surrounds the structure, as if sunlight dares not touch its malevolent facade. Its towering spires are wrapped in withered vines, and its gateways yawn like the gaping mouths of forgotten horrors. Inside, the air is suffocating and thick with the scent of damp stone and decayed offerings. Faint whispers echo through the dark corridors, carrying fragmented words in a language long lost to time.

NO MAN'S LAND

SETUP

Open terrain, trenches, long lines of sight.

EFFECTS

Artillery Strike: At the start of each Turn after the first, select one random Tile. All Units on that Tile take 2 ranged Damage.

PRINT-AT-HOME

- [No Man's Land - A4](#)
- [No Man's Land - US Letter](#)

A barren expanse scarred by endless war, No Man's Land stretches between the shattered frontlines of long-dead armies. The ground is churned to mud and ash, cratered by orbital barrages and scarred by the rusting skeletons of tanks and walkers. Jagged trench lines crisscross the battlefield like open wounds, some still slick with blood and oil. Barbed wire tangles and sun-bleached corpses mark the no-go zones, while distant artillery thunders like the last breath of a dying god. Visibility is cruelly clear; any movement invites death from a mile away. There is no cover, no mercy. Only survival, moment to moment.

